DDD-C-450B
January 26, 1976
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. DDD-C-450A
March 7, 1966

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CLOTHS, POLISHING (FOR ELECTRICAL CONTACT SURFACES)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers requirements for cotton cloths of one type and size primarily used for cleaning and polishing electrical contact surfaces (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specification:

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Std. No. 191 - Textile Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standard:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspections by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Laws and Regulation:

Rules and Regulations Under the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act 16 CFR 303.

(The Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) and the Federal Register (FR) are for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402. When indicated, reprints of certain regulations may be obtained from the Federal agency responsible for issuance thereof).

FSC 7920

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Base cloth. The cloth shall be woven, made from cotton which has been cleaned, carded or combed, and evenly spun into single yarns, when tested as specified in 4.2.4.

3.1.1.1 Yarns per inch. The number of yarns per inch in the warp direction shall be 50 ± 2 and in the filling direction 38 ± 2, when tested as specified in 4.2.4.

3.1.1.2 Breaking strength. The minimum breaking strength shall be 25 pounds in the warp direction and 17 pounds in the filling direction when tested as specified in 4.2.4.

3.1.1.3 Finish. The base cloth shall have a soft finish and shall be lightly napped on both sides (see 4.2.2.1.1).

3.1.2 Finishing compound. The finishing compound shall be composed of a silica base suitable for the purpose intended when tested in accordance with 4.2.4.

3.1.3 Finished cloth. In addition to the requirements of 3.1.1 through 3.1.1.3, the following requirements apply to the finished cloth.

3.1.3.1 Weight. The finished cloths shall weigh not less than 7.0 ounces per squares yard when tested in accordance with 4.2.4.

3.1.3.2 Treatment. The silica compound applied to the base cloth to obtain the desired finish shall be accomplished by a dipping process which shall thoroughly impregnate the cloth. The color of the cloth shall be white (bleached) (see 4.2.2.1.1).

3.1.4 Size cloths. The cut to size cloths in any one sample shall average not less than 10.75 x 13.25 inches when measured in accordance with 4.2.2.1.2. A tolerance of minus 1/4 inch in either or both dimension of the above size is permitted for individual cloths.

3.1.5 Edges. All edges of cut to size cloths, other than selvage edges shall be pinked or overedge stitched. (see 4.2.2.1.1).

3.1.5.1 Overedge stitching. When overedged stitching is employed it shall be accomplished by use of not less than two threads to form the stitch, each tread construction of 2 ply bleached or mericerized cotton yarn. There shall be 10 to 12 stitches per inch.

3.2 Fiber identification. Each cloth shall be labeled, ticketed, or invoiced for fiber content in accordance with the Rules and Regulations Under the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act (see 2.1).

3.3 Preproduction sample. When specified, before production is commenced, a finished sample of the size cloth required by the specification shall be submitted to the contracting officer for approval. Approval of the preproduction sample authorizes production. Such production does not relieve the contractor of the responsibility for compliance with all provisions of this specification.

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3.4 Workmanship. The cloths shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification and the occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels. (AQL's).

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. Where certificates of compliance are authorized, the Government reserves the right to check test items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter. For purposes of sampling, an inspection lot for acceptance inspection and tests shall consist of all polishing cloths submitted for inspection and delivery at one time.

4.2.1 Inspection of materials and components. In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that materials and components used were manufactured, tested, and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified, or, if none, in accordance with this specification. In the event of conflict, this specification shall govern.

4.2.2 Inspection of the end item.

4.2.2.1 Examination of the end item. Examination of the end item shall be made in accordance with classification of defects, inspection levels, and AQL's set forth as follows. The lot size, for purpose of determining the sample size in accordance with MIL-STD-105, shall be expressed in units of polishing cloths for examinations in 4.2.2.1.1 and 4.2.2.1.2.

4.2.2.1.1 Examination of the end item for defects in appearance, construction, and workmanship. The sample unit for this examination shall be one polishing cloth.

Examine	Defect
Appearance, construction, and workmanship	Any hole, cut, or tear. Spot, stain, or streak affecting serviceability or seriously affecting appearance. Lumps or embedded foreign matter. Edges not pinked or overedge stitched, other than selvage edges. Not bleached white. Not woven. Not a soft finish and not lightly napped on both sides.

4.2.2.1.2 Examination of the end item for defects in dimensions. The sample unit for this examination shall be one polishing cloth.

Defects

Average size in any one sample size less than 142.0 square inches.
Any individual cloth varies more than minus 1/4 inch on either or both dimensions of the minimum size 10.75 x 13.25.

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4.2.2.1.3 Inspection levels and AQL's for examinations. The inspection levels for determining the sample size, and the AQL's expressed in defects per 100 units shall be as follows:

Examination paragraph	Inspection level	AQL
4.2.2.1.1	S-4	2.5
4.2.2.1.2:		
Average unit	S-2	---
Individual unit	S-2	2.5

4.2.3 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements comply with section 5. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the following list. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. Defects of closure listed as follows shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per 100 units in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, improper taping, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Open and noncontinuous heat sealed seam of polyethylene bag. Omission of vent hole in polyethylene bag.
Content	Bulging or distortion of containers. Number per container is more or less than required.

4.2.4 Testing of the end item. Testing of the end item shall be made for the applicable characteristics as indicated in table I for each lot presented for inspection. The lot size shall be expressed in units of polishing cloths. The sample unit shall be two polishing cloths. Five sample units randomly taken from throughout the lot shall be tested. The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more sample units fail to meet any test requirement specified.

TABLE I. Test requirements

Characteristic	Requirement reference	Test method[1]	Number of determinations per individual sample unit[2]	Results reported as:
Fiber identification	3.1.1	1200	1	Pass or fail.
Ply of yarn	3.1.1	Visual	1	Pass or fail.
Yarns per inch	3.1.1.1	5050	3	Average of 3 determinations to nearest whole number.
Breaking strength	3.1.1.2	5100	3	Average of 3 determinations to nearest whole number.
Finishing compound	3.1.2	Certificate of compliance[3]	--	Pass or fail.
Weight	3.1.3.1	5041	3	Average of 3 determination to nearest whole number.

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TABLE I. Test requirements (con't)

Characteristic	Requirement reference	Test method[1]	Number of determinations per individual sample unit[2]	Results reported as:
Overedge stitching number of sewing treads for forming stitch	3.1.5.1	Visual	1	Pass or fail
Identification of cotton	3.1.5.1	1200	1	Pass or fail
Yarns per sewing thread	3.1.5.1	Visual	1	Pass or fail
Finish of thread	3.1.5.1	Visual	1	Pass of fail
Stitches per inch	3.1.5.1	Visual	3	Average of 3 determinations

1 Tests shall be performed in accordance with methods of Fed. Std. 191, Textile Test Methods, except that the stipulation as to the number of specimens to test, number of determinations to make, or number of results to report shall not apply.

2 Test report shall include all values on which average results are based.

3 A certificate of compliance shall be required from the manufacturer stating that his product meets the requirements for finishing compound.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each polishing cloth, compactly folded, shall be packaged in an end opening 40-pound kraft envelope. The open end shall be provided with a flap type closure. The flap shall have a reinforced hole, centered 5/8 ± 1/16 inch from the end of the flap. A metal clasp shall be secured in place on the envelope in a location so that when the envelope flap is folded, the clasp and hole will coincide.

5.1.1.1 When specified, twelve polishing cloths shall be neatly stacked and placed in a snug-fitting flat or square style clear polyethylene film bag of 0.00125 inch thickness (± 20 percent tolerance). The polyethylene bag shall be formed with heat sealed seams that are straight and continuous and shall be effected by heat sealing with the heat seal made as close as possible to the open end. A 1/4-inch diameter hole shall be made at one corner of each bag to allow excess air to escape. Alternatively, a mechanical tie (paper or plastic covered soft steel wire, aluminum band, etc.) shall be applied to close the bag opening (see 6.2).

5.1.2 Level C. Each polishing cloth shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Six hundred polishing cloths, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, V3c or V3s of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed, waterproofed, and reinforced with flat steel strapping or tape banding in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Six hundred polishing cloths, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, type CF or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Each container shall be closed method II in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The cloths shall be packed in accordance with the supplier's standard commercial practice. Shipping container shall comply with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification as applicable.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

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5.3.2 Military requirements. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.3.3 Polyethylene bagged packages. Polyethylene bagged packages shall have the required information legibly printed or stamped in black directly on the bag across the center face or on a white paper label inserted within the bag so as to permit ready identification. The bag or label shall indicate the following information:

STOCK NUMBER
NOMENCLATURE
QUANTITY

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The cloths covered by this specification are intended for use in cleaning and burnishing electrical contact surfaces of metallic component parts and hardware such as telephone switchboard plugs and jacks, relays and relay housings, potentiometer housings, contactor rings, switches, etc.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Whether preproduction sample is required (see 3.3).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) Whether packaging in polyethylene bags is required (see 5.1.1.1).

Preparing activity:

GSA - FSS

Civil Agencies Interest:

GSA - FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See Section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 30 cents each.

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